Jade River Resort

Website Project Brief

Prepared for: Development Team / Intern

Property of: Defoy Hotels & Resorts

Document purpose: everything needed to design and build the Jade River Resort website from scratch — property information, brand direction, design system, technical requirements, and site structure.

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1. Project Overview

Jade River Resort is a luxury boutique resort in Pahalgam, Jammu & Kashmir, on the banks of the Lidder River. It is part of the Defoy Hotels & Resorts group. The goal of this project is to design and build a premium, modern, animation-rich website that positions Jade River as a distinctive, high-end destination — not a generic hotel-booking template.

Core brand line: "Life, Slowed by the River." Every design and content decision should reinforce this idea of slowing down, being immersed in nature, and boutique/personal attention (only 13 rooms total).

Goals

- A visually distinctive, animated, premium-feeling website — not an "outdated" template-style hotel site.
- Strong SEO, AEO (Answer Engine Optimization), and GEO (Generative Engine Optimization) — the site should rank well in both traditional search and AI answer engines (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews).
- Fully mobile-responsive, fast-loading, accessible.
- Direct booking focus — the resort does not use OTAs (MakeMyTrip, Booking.com, etc.); booking happens directly via WhatsApp/contact.

2. About Jade River Resort

Jade River Resort is a luxury boutique resort in Pahalgam, Kashmir, built on the banks of the Lidder River. It is not just a hotel — it is designed as an experience. The philosophy is "Life, Slowed by the River": guests come here to get away from city life, be immersed in nature, and live at a slower, more peaceful pace.

The resort's buildings use wooden architecture with warm amber lighting and stone pathways. There is a small stream in front of the property, and dense Kashmiri pine forest behind it. Every design choice is meant to make guests feel connected to nature.

Location	Pahalgam, Jammu & Kashmir, India
On the banks of	Lidder River
Parent brand	Defoy Hotels & Resorts
Elevation	2,130 metres
Total rooms	13 (boutique property)
Booking policy	Direct only — no OTAs. Booking via website contact form or WhatsApp.
Phone / WhatsApp	+91 7780868926

Email	info@xogul.com
Address	Pahalgam, Jammu & Kashmir — 192125

3. Rooms & Suites (13 Total)

Room Type	Count	Price From	Notes
Premium Balcony Room	9 rooms	₹6,000/night	Private balcony, mountain & resort views, luxury bedding, WiFi, room service. Most popular option.
Executive Suite	2 suites	₹8,000/night	Large living space, premium interiors, king bed, luxury bathroom. Best for couples & special occasions.
Executive Duplex Family Room	2 rooms	₹13,000/night	Two-level duplex layout, designed for families, children get their own floor.

4. Experiences

- **Bonfire Evenings —** Lidder River ke kinare bonfire, Kashmiri raat, taare, aur paani ki awaaz. Family, partner, ya akele bhi enjoy kar sakte hain.
- **River Walks —** Lidder River ke saath walk, koi fixed schedule ya guide nahi, apni marzi se.
- **Pahalgam Sightseeing —** Baisaran Valley (Mini Switzerland), Aru Valley, Betaab Valley, Chandanwari — sab resort se thodi door.
- **Photography —** Wooden buildings, stream, forest — har corner ek perfect frame.
- **Family Moments —** Spacious lawns, safe environment, family-friendly activities, duplex rooms.
- **Pure Luxury —** Room service, premium bedding, attentive staff — luxury jo dikhti nahi, feel hoti hai.

5. Location

- Pahalgam — Kashmir ka premier hill station, 2,130 metres ki height par.
- Srinagar Airport se: ~96 km, 2.5 to 3 ghante by road.
- Nearby: Aru Valley, Betaab Valley, Chandanwari, Amarnath route.
- Exact coordinates: 33.883354, 75.269764.

6. Who This Resort Is For

Guest Type	Why It Fits
Couples & Honeymooners	Romantic setting, river, private suites
Families	Duplex rooms, safe lawns, activities
Delhi / Mumbai / Bangalore Travelers	Weekend escape, cool weather
NRI & International Tourists	Authentic Kashmir luxury
Photography Lovers	Stunning natural frames
Corporate Retreats	Peaceful, away from the city

7. Reservation, Cancellation & Stay Policies

Full policy content is provided as a separate document ("Defoy Policies Page Content") and must be transcribed verbatim onto a dedicated /policies page — do not paraphrase legal/operational content. Key points every page/section should reflect correctly:

- **Cancellation:** 15+ days before arrival = full refund. 15–10 days before = 50% retention charge. Within 10 days = 100% retention.
- **Check-in / Check-out:** Check-in 2:00 PM, Check-out 12:00 Noon.
- **Payment:** Minimum 50% advance required to confirm a booking.
- **ID requirement:** Valid government photo ID at check-in. Foreign nationals need passport + visa. PAN card is not accepted as address/ID proof.
- **Contact for policy queries:** info@defoy.in (reservations), accounts@defoy.in (GST/invoices).

Note: the resort-specific contact (info@xogul.com) is used for direct guest/booking enquiries; the defoy.in addresses are the group-level policy/accounts contacts. Keep both distinct and correct in the right places.

8. Brand Voice & Design Direction

The site must NOT look like a generic, outdated hotel template. It should feel premium, cinematic, and distinctive — like a boutique lifestyle brand, not a booking-engine skin.

Brand voice

- Warm, unhurried, specific — never generic "luxury" marketing filler.
- References real, concrete detail: the wooden architecture, the stream, the pine forest, the sound of the river — not vague adjectives.
- The line "Life, Slowed by the River" should echo across the site (hero, philosophy section, etc.) without being repeated word-for-word everywhere — vary it.

Color palette

Name	Hex	Usage
Deep Pine (background)	#101F19	Primary dark background across the site
Pine 900	#16281F	Secondary panel/section background
Wood Amber	#8A5A2E	Warm structural accent — wood/architecture references
Lidder River Teal	#4C978C	Primary brand accent — links, highlights, the signature 'RiverLine' motif
River Light	#7BB8AE	Lighter accent variant, hover states
Stone / Cream	#E7E0D2	Primary text on dark backgrounds, light section backgrounds
Ember	#C88A44	Call-to-action buttons, badges, WhatsApp button
Ink	#0B140F	Deepest background / footer

Typography

- Display / headings: Fraunces (serif, has a warm, carved-wood character). Use italics for accent words within headlines.
- Body text: Inter (light/regular weights for a refined, uncluttered feel).
- Labels / data / eyebrows / prices: Space Mono, uppercase, letter-spaced — used for small utility text like "FROM ₹6,000/NIGHT" or section eyebrows.

Signature visual motif

A thin animated line (styled like a flowing river / current) that reappears across the site in different forms — e.g. as a scroll-progress indicator in the hero, as a divider in the Philosophy section, as a route-line in the Location section. This ties every section back to the river/"slowed down" concept instead of feeling like disconnected sections.

9. Recommended Tech Stack

- **Framework:** Next.js 15+ (App Router), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.
- **Animation:** Framer Motion for component-level animation and scroll-linked effects; CSS transitions + IntersectionObserver for simple fade/reveal animations (lighter weight, better mobile performance than using a JS library for everything).
- **Smooth scroll:** Lenis (disabled on mobile/reduced-motion for performance).
- **CMS:** Sanity CMS — used for the blog/journal, guest reviews (moderated), and any other content the client should be able to update without a code deploy.
- **Video:** YouTube Data API v3 to auto-pull videos from the resort's YouTube playlist — no manual re-upload needed when new videos are added.
- **Hosting:** Vercel (or equivalent Next.js-compatible host).
- **Deployment path:** The site will live at defoyhotelsandresorts.com/jade-river-resort (a sub-path of the parent group's domain, alongside sibling properties like Amber Spring and Twin Towers) — this requires Next.js basePath configuration. Confirm the exact deployment approach with whoever manages the parent domain before finalizing this.

10. Key Features to Build

A. Animation & Interaction (every section should feel intentional, not templated)

- Cinematic video hero with staggered text reveal on load.
- Scroll-triggered reveal animations throughout (fade + slide, respecting prefers-reduced-motion).
- Parallax imagery in at least one storytelling section.
- 3D tilt-on-hover for card elements (rooms, blog posts) — desktop only, disabled on touch devices.
- A distinctive gallery treatment for property photos (e.g. a rotating 3D image ring/carousel) rather than a plain grid.
- Smooth, physics-based scrolling site-wide.

B. Core Pages

Route	Purpose
/	Homepage — cinematic single-page narrative: Hero, Philosophy, Rooms, Experiences, Gallery, Journal teaser, Video teaser, Reviews teaser, Location, closing CTA

Route	Purpose
/rooms	Full room listing (all 3 types)
/rooms/[slug]	Individual room detail page — gallery, full description, amenities, price, Reserve CTA
/experiences	Full experiences listing (all 6, alternating layout)
/gallery	Full photo gallery
/location	Directions, map, nearby attractions
/contact	Direct booking — room selector + WhatsApp deep-link
/policies	Full reservation, cancellation, payment & stay policies
/faq	Frequently asked questions (written for both humans and AI search engines)
/post	Blog / Journal listing
/post/[slug]	Blog post detail
/reviews	Guest reviews — stats, review grid, submission form

C. Booking Flow

- No OTA integration. Booking is direct-only.
- Primary CTA ("Reserve Directly") leads to a contact page with a room selector.
- Selecting a room + optional dates/guests/name builds a pre-filled WhatsApp message via a wa.me link.
- A persistent floating WhatsApp button should be present site-wide as a lower-friction alternative entry point.

D. Blog / Journal (Sanity CMS powered)

- Content team can publish posts from Sanity Studio without a code deploy.
- Rich content blocks: standard text, images, tables, comparison tables, CTA buttons, callout boxes, and raw HTML blocks.
- Full SEO control per post (meta title, meta description, focus keyword, canonical URL, OG image).
- URL structure: /post/[slug].

E. YouTube Video Section

- Automatically pulls the latest videos from the resort's YouTube playlist.
- Videos open in an in-page lightbox (user never leaves the site).

- New videos appear automatically — no code changes needed.

F. Guest Reviews (moderated)

- Guests submit reviews via a form on the site.
- Reviews are NOT published instantly — they go into Sanity as a draft, and an admin manually approves them before they appear publicly.
- Only 3, 4, or 5-star ratings are accepted through the public form (prevents unfair 1–2 star reviews, typically from non-guests or competitors).

11. SEO, AEO & GEO Requirements

This is a high priority for the client. "AEO" (Answer Engine Optimization) and "GEO" (Generative Engine Optimization) mean making sure AI systems like ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews can accurately find, understand, and cite information about the resort — not just traditional Google search ranking.

Required technical SEO elements

- Structured data (JSON-LD): LodgingBusiness schema site-wide (name, address, geo-coordinates, price range, amenities), HotelRoom schema per room page, FAQPage schema on the FAQ page, BreadcrumbList on every inner page, AggregateRating once real reviews exist.
- A dedicated, thorough FAQ page written in clear, self-contained Q&A pairs — this is what AI answer engines quote most directly. Cover location, pricing, booking policy, and experiences.
- An llms.txt file at the site root — a plain-text summary of the resort for AI crawlers to read directly.
- robots.txt should explicitly allow AI crawlers (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, Google-Extended, CCBot) alongside standard search engine bots.
- A dynamic XML sitemap covering every static page and every dynamic route (rooms, blog posts).
- Unique, accurate metadata (title + description) on every page — never duplicate across pages.
- Canonical URLs on every page.
- Descriptive image alt text everywhere — specific, not keyword-stuffed.

Performance requirements

- Mobile-first: test and optimize for mobile before desktop.
- Core Web Vitals matter for both traditional SEO and AI-crawler trust — avoid layout shift (CLS), minimize main-thread blocking time (TBT), and keep Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) fast.
- Compress and responsively serve all video/image assets — never ship a multi-MB unoptimized video to mobile.

12. Assets Provided

Real resort photography and video are available and should be used throughout — do not use stock photography or placeholder images for the final site. Assets include:

- Aerial/drone video of the property (wooden buildings, river, surrounding land).
- Property exterior photography (wooden facade, stream/pathway).
- Room interiors (to be provided per room type).
- A YouTube channel/playlist with resort story videos.

Request any additional photos needed (each room type, dining, bonfire evenings, forest/pine surroundings, family lawn areas) directly from the resort/client rather than substituting stock imagery.

13. Important Notes

- This is a boutique, direct-booking-only property — do not build or suggest OTA integrations.
- The site is one of several Defoy Hotels & Resorts properties (others include Amber Spring, Twin Towers) that will eventually live under the same parent domain as sub-paths — keep the codebase and content structure clean enough that the same approach could reasonably be reused for a sibling property.
- Always confirm real data (coordinates, policies, pricing, contact details) against this document or the client directly — never invent or guess specific facts, especially anything related to pricing, policy, or contact information.
- Accessibility matters: keyboard navigation, proper alt text, sufficient color contrast, and respecting prefers-reduced-motion are not optional polish — they are required.